

Ashcombe Advisory Partners LLC

www.ashcombeadvisory.com

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DRAFT -- superseded by the final version; not for distribution

Robert Smith
VP Finance
Gallegos, Pope and Marsh

Dear Mr. Smith:

This letter sets out the terms on which our firm will carry out a reputation audit for Gallegos, Pope and Marsh, and it becomes our agreement once you have countersigned and returned it. We have written it in plain terms, so that it reads as a fair record of the conversation we have had rather than as a document to be decoded. Where the language is careful, it is careful for your protection as much as for ours.

Please read it against your own understanding of what we discussed. If any line here sits at odds with that, tell us before you sign, and we will put it right together. Nothing in these pages is meant to surprise you later.

The Audit We Propose

We propose to examine how Gallegos, Pope and Marsh is understood today by the audiences whose view of the company carries the most weight: its investors, the trade and financial press that cover it, and the people inside the company who speak for it. Our aim is a clear, evidence-based account of where the company's reputation is strong, where it is exposed, and where the distance between how the company sees itself and how it is seen runs widest.

The audit will draw on the company's recent public communications, the coverage those communications have attracted, and a set of confidential conversations with people you nominate. It does not extend to the running of the company or to decisions that are properly yours; where our findings touch those decisions, they remain findings, and the judgment stays with you.

How We Will Work

We begin by reading the record: the announcements, filings, and materials the company has issued, set beside the press and analyst commentary they drew. From there we listen, in a small number of confidential interviews with the executives and outside parties you point us to, so that what people actually believe is placed next to what the company has said about itself.

We then bring the two together into a written assessment, tested with you before it is final, that names the strengths worth protecting and the risks worth addressing. Because so much of this work moves by correspondence, we keep a clean record of what we send and route anything sensitive through a single point on each side, so that you always know where a given thread stands and never have to hunt for the current version.

The People on the Work

Michelle Rose will carry the engagement day to day and will be your first point of contact for anything of substance. She does the close work on the drafting and keeps the moving parts legible, and she is the person to bring a question to when it needs a quick answer.

Kimberly Le will handle the media and analyst review, reading how the company's story is moving across the coverage and compressing a noisy record into something you can act on. I will keep a hand on the work myself, and particularly on the sensitive findings; nothing of weight will leave our office under our name without my having read it. You are welcome to come to me directly at any time, though Michelle Rose will usually be the quicker route to an answer.

Fee and Start

Our fee for the audit is \$45,500, covering the work described above through the delivery of our written assessment. The engagement will begin on February 12, 2024 and is expected to run about four months from that point, though we will treat it as finished when the work is genuinely done rather than when the calendar says so.

Fees and Payment

We will invoice against the fee as the work proceeds, and our invoices are payable within thirty days of receipt. The fee covers our people and their time; it does not cover out-of-pocket costs such as travel or third-party research, which we will agree with you before anything of consequence is incurred. Should the scope of the audit

change materially, we will raise the matter with you and settle the fee before that additional work begins.

Term and Termination

Either of us may bring the engagement to a close on fourteen days' written notice. If you end it, you will owe us for the work properly completed to that point and for any costs already committed on your behalf, and nothing beyond that. We would, of course, hope to talk before it came to that.

Confidentiality

Everything we learn about Gallegos, Pope and Marsh in the course of the audit we will hold in confidence and use only for this engagement. That obligation binds our whole team, survives the end of our work together, and covers the fact of our involvement as much as its substance. We ask the same of you for the methods and materials we share with you.

Limitation of Liability

We will carry out the audit with the care and skill you are entitled to expect, and we stand behind our work. We do not, however, control how the press, the markets, or other third parties will finally read the company, and so our liability to you under this engagement is limited to the fees paid under it, except in those respects where the law does not permit such a limit.

Governing Law

This agreement is governed by the law of the state in which our firm is established, and any dispute arising under it will be resolved in that state's courts. Should any single provision be found unenforceable, the remainder of this letter stands unaffected.

If this reflects our understanding, please countersign below and return one copy to us, keeping the other for your files. Once it is back with us, Michelle Rose will be in touch to arrange the first conversations and to ask for the materials we will need to begin. We are glad to be starting this work with the Gallegos, Pope and Marsh team.